

UNITED STRENGTH CLUB HOMEPAGE // DEVELOPMENT DIRECTION

Rob,

Here is the updated direction for the United Strength homepage.

A lot of the individual design language you have established is working, particularly the numbering, typography, thin rules, minimal interface, and subtle animation. The primary changes are to the architecture and progression of the homepage, the overall scale of the typography, the navigation, and the shift toward a darker visual system.

01 // OVERALL VISUAL DIRECTION

The homepage should be dark-first.

Use deep charcoal / black as the primary background environment with warm cream / beige typography rather than stark white.

Cream or light backgrounds can still be used selectively as intentional visual chapter breaks, but they should not be the dominant treatment throughout the homepage.

Keep the editorial language already established in the current build:

- Numbering
- Thin rules and dividers
- Editorial typography
- Minimal interface elements
- Restrained animation
- Strong negative space

The primary typography change is SCALE.

The typography throughout the opening experience is currently too small, particularly the chapter numbers, chapter titles, supporting text, and progression information at the bottom of the screen.

Increase the scale significantly.

It should remain restrained and editorial, but it needs substantially more presence and immediate readability.

02 // HEADER

Keep the minimal centered header treatment.

Increase the size of UNITED STRENGTH significantly from the current implementation. It should have much more presence without becoming oversized or feeling like a conventional gym logo/header.

Directly underneath, simplify the current location/date/time treatment.

Use this format:

COLUMBUS, OH // 08.31.26 // 3:33 PM

The date and time should update dynamically.

Format:

COLUMBUS, OH // MM.DD.YY // 12-HOUR TIME WITH AM/PM

Keep the header transformation that already occurs as the visitor moves from the opening experience into the website. We like that behavior.

Use the correct final United Strength brand mark in the transformed header.

03 // DESKTOP NAVIGATION

Remove the current full-screen navigation overlay.

Replace it with a left-side navigation drawer using the Aimé Leon Dore reference provided as the layout/behavior reference.

The drawer should occupy approximately 28% of the desktop viewport width.

When opened:

- The drawer enters from the left.
- The website remains visible to the right.
- The drawer background is deep charcoal / black.
- Keep the numbered navigation treatment you already created.
- Keep the existing navigation typography.
- Keep the thin horizontal divider treatment.

- Keep the interaction minimal and clean.
- Keep a simple CLOSE interaction.

Use the new United Strength crest as a large background watermark inside the drawer.

The crest should be:

- Oversized
- Very low opacity
- Partially cropped
- Positioned behind the navigation
- Visible enough to create texture and identity without competing with the menu

The concept is similar to the ghosted mark in the Aimé Leon Dore navigation reference, but executed specifically with the United Strength crest.

04 // OPENING EXPERIENCE

This is the biggest architectural change to the current homepage.

The current opening sequence is built vertically.

It needs to become ONE FULL-SCREEN HORIZONTAL CAROUSEL.

There are four chapters:

01 // UNITED STRENGTH CLUB

→

02 // WHAT WE BELIEVE

→

03 // THE FOUR Pillars

→

04 // EXPERIENCE UNITED

These are NOT four vertically stacked homepage sections.

They are four states within the same full-screen opening carousel.

The visitor progresses horizontally through:

01 → 02 → 03 → 04

Only after completing the opening carousel does the visitor begin moving vertically through the remainder of the homepage.

The opening should feel like an editorial/cinematic introduction to United Strength rather than four separate pages stacked vertically.

05 // OPENING CAROUSEL MEDIA

The carousel should intentionally use a mixture of media.

Depending on the individual chapter, this can include:

- Short cinematic video loops
- Still photography
- Subtle animated / GIF-style imagery

Do not force all four slides into the same media format.

We will determine the strongest media for each chapter and create/source content specifically for that purpose.

Movement should be subtle and cinematic.

This should NOT feel like a fast-cut promotional gym reel.

Even though the media can change from chapter to chapter, the color treatment, typography, composition, pacing, and overall art direction should make the four slides feel like one cohesive visual world.

06 // CAROUSEL TYPOGRAPHY + PROGRESSION

Keep the numbered editorial treatment already established.

For example:

01

// UNITED STRENGTH CLUB

Increase the size substantially from the current implementation.

The lower-left typography currently disappears too easily into the media.

The chapter number and title need significantly more visual presence.

Remove the current:

SCROLL ↓

treatment between these opening chapters.

The visitor is progressing horizontally, not vertically.

Replace it with a minimal horizontal progression/navigation treatment that clearly communicates that there are four chapters and that the visitor can move left/right through them.

Do not make this look like a conventional image carousel with large arrows or generic navigation dots.

Keep it minimal, editorial, and consistent with the existing design language.

07 // CAROUSEL 01
UNITED STRENGTH CLUB

This is the first screen someone sees when entering the website.

Use:

01
// UNITED STRENGTH CLUB

Hero statement:

A strength community for people who want more from their gym and life.

Do not use:

(THE CLUB)

underneath it.

The opening media can be a short seamless video loop or another subtle-motion treatment that immediately establishes the visual world of United Strength.

This is the first impression of the entire website, so the media and typography need enough scale and presence to establish the brand immediately.

08 // CAROUSEL 02 WHAT WE BELIEVE

The second carousel chapter is:

02 // WHAT WE BELIEVE

This replaces the current vertically scrolling What We Believe screen.

It should occupy the same full-screen carousel environment established in Slide 01.

The purpose of this chapter is to introduce the philosophy behind United Strength without turning the opening experience into a long manifesto.

Keep this visually driven and restrained.

09 // CAROUSEL 03 THE FOUR PILLARS

The Four Pillars should NOT scroll vertically one at a time as they currently do.

This entire chapter should remain ONE horizontal, full-screen carousel slide.

Within that one full-width horizontal image/frame, split the screen VERTICALLY into four equal sections so all four pillars are visible at the same time.

The layout should read as:

| PILLAR 01 | PILLAR 02 | PILLAR 03 | PILLAR 04 |

Each vertical section should occupy approximately 25% of the screen width.

Use subtle vertical dividing lines or natural image separation so the four areas feel distinct without making them look like four separate cards.

Each vertical section should include:

- Its own purpose-created visual
- Its corresponding United Strength symbol / logo
- Its pillar name

The important visual idea is that the visitor sees ALL FOUR PILLARS together across one wide horizontal frame.

The screen is horizontal.

The divisions are vertical.

All four pillars are visible simultaneously.

Do NOT make the visitor swipe through the pillars individually.

Do NOT stack the pillars vertically.

Do NOT create four separate full-screen pillar slides.

The four visuals should be art-directed as one cohesive collection rather than feeling like four unrelated images.

The imagery can consist of specifically shot photography, art-directed imagery, AI-generated imagery, subtle motion, or a combination depending on what best serves each pillar.

The structural requirement is:

ONE HORIZONTAL FULL-SCREEN FRAME.

FOUR VERTICAL DIVISIONS.

FOUR PILLARS VISIBLE AT ONCE.

10 // CAROUSEL 04

EXPERIENCE UNITED

The fourth and final carousel chapter is:

04

// EXPERIENCE UNITED

This completes the opening sequence.

It should remain immersive, visual, and consistent with the cinematic/editorial language established across the first three chapters.

Do NOT use the current large white:

5 CLASSES

14 DAYS

START HERE

treatment as the fourth carousel chapter.

Experience United within the opening carousel is part of the brand introduction, not a conventional trial/pricing block.

Once the visitor completes Experience United, the website transitions into the vertical homepage.

11 // VERTICAL HOMEPAGE ARCHITECTURE

After the four-part opening carousel, the remainder of the homepage should be concise.

We do not want an unnecessarily long homepage.

The opening carousel is doing a significant amount of the brand storytelling, so the vertical portion should give visitors the right pathways deeper into the website without trying to explain everything United Strength does.

The homepage progression is:

OPENING CAROUSEL

01 // UNITED STRENGTH CLUB

02 // WHAT WE BELIEVE

03 // THE FOUR PILLARS

04 // EXPERIENCE UNITED



WHAT WE OFFER



THE SPACE / EXPERIENCE



MEMBERSHIP



START HERE



FOOTER

12 // WHAT WE OFFER

This should function as a concise, image-led gateway into the deeper United Strength ecosystem rather than a long list of every service or program.

The visual treatment should remain editorial and use strong horizontal / landscape imagery with minimal text.

The purpose is to give the visitor clear pathways deeper into the website without turning the homepage into a service directory.

Keep this section visually strong, simple, and clickable.

13 // THE SPACE / EXPERIENCE

This should be an image-led editorial section.

Use strong horizontal / landscape photography and, where appropriate, smaller layered detail imagery to communicate the physical environment and hospitality of United Strength.

The photography should have a clear purpose rather than functioning as a decorative gallery.

This is one area where the layered editorial photography concept already explored in the current build can be useful, but it needs to have a clear hierarchy and purpose.

The visitor should immediately understand that this section is about the physical United Strength environment.

CTA:

EXPLORE THE SPACE →

This can also be one of the intentional places where the homepage transitions into a warm cream background as a visual chapter break before returning to the darker environment for Membership.

14 // MEMBERSHIP

Membership should create a noticeable visual shift.

Move away from large lifestyle photography here.

Return to a dark charcoal / black environment and let typography, numbers, movement, rules, and identity carry the section.

The visual direction is:

PRIVATE-CLUB PASSPORT
MEMBERSHIP CREDENTIAL
ARCHIVAL DOCUMENT

The section should feel influenced by a passport, membership record, identification document, or private-club credential rather than conventional gym pricing.

Use:

- Dark charcoal / black
- Warm cream typography
- Strong numerical hierarchy
- Membership identification details
- Serial-number / credential-style information
- Thin rules
- Subtle crest watermark
- Editorial document-style typography
- Generous negative space

Do NOT use conventional gym pricing cards.

Keep and expand upon the animated-number treatment already being explored in the current build.

We like the movement/animation you have already created with numbers.

Numbers can subtly:

- Reveal
- Transition
- Change
- Move into position

The movement should feel:

MECHANICAL

EDITORIAL

REFINED

It should NOT feel:

TECHY

FLASHY

GIMMICKY

The complete passport-style membership system will live on the Membership page.

The homepage should introduce and preview that world rather than trying to put the entire membership system here.

CTA:

EXPLORE MEMBERSHIP →

15 // START HERE

The final conversion section should become extremely simple again.

After the visual complexity and movement of the homepage, this should feel decisive and clear.

Primary statement:

YOUR NEXT CHAPTER STARTS HERE.

Give the visitor two clear paths:

EXPERIENCE UNITED →

APPLY FOR MEMBERSHIP →

Do not create another intermediate CTA that makes the visitor click START HERE only to then choose between these options.

The options themselves are the actions.

16 // CTA LANGUAGE

CTA language throughout the homepage should be direct and destination-specific.

Use:

EXPERIENCE UNITED →

APPLY FOR MEMBERSHIP →

EXPLORE THE SPACE →

EXPLORE MEMBERSHIP →

Avoid vague or decorative language as clickable navigation.

Do not use the current:

ARCHITECTURE

BELONGING BEFORE TRANSACTION

BEGIN TRIAL

as CTAs.

"Belonging before transaction" can function as editorial/brand language where appropriate, but it should not function as navigation.

17 // FOOTER

Substantially simplify the current footer.

The current footer contains too many links, individual programs, email addresses, and secondary pieces of information competing for attention.

The new footer should use:

- Deep charcoal / black background
- Warm cream typography
- Significant negative space
- Strong United Strength identity
- United Strength crest with meaningful visual presence
- Minimal navigation
- Minimal legal information along the bottom

Organize the footer into three simple groups:

EXPLORE

About
Training
Membership
The Space

JOIN

Experience United
Apply for Membership

CONNECT

Instagram
Contact
Columbus, Ohio

Along the bottom:

© UNITED STRENGTH CLUB
PRIVACY
TERMS

The footer should feel like the quiet closing page of the United Strength experience.

It should NOT feel like another sitemap or directory.

FINAL HOMEPAGE PROGRESSION

01 // UNITED STRENGTH CLUB

A strength community for people who want more from their gym and life.

→

02 // WHAT WE BELIEVE

→

03 // THE FOUR PILLARS

→

04 // EXPERIENCE UNITED

↓

WHAT WE OFFER

↓

THE SPACE / EXPERIENCE
EXPLORE THE SPACE →

↓

MEMBERSHIP
Passport / private-club credential treatment
Animated number treatment
EXPLORE MEMBERSHIP →

↓

YOUR NEXT CHAPTER STARTS HERE.

EXPERIENCE UNITED →
APPLY FOR MEMBERSHIP →

↓

SIMPLIFIED DARK FOOTER